Lunch

HE strategic session 4

29 January 2026

Agenda

Time	Topic
12:00 – 13:00	Lunch
13:00 – 13:15	Department announcements
13:15 – 14:30	Activity 1A: Exploring HE section scenarios for the future
14-30 – 15:00	Activity 1B: Scenario positioning & preference/ Coffee Break
15:00 – 16:30	Activity 2: Cross departmental working groups
16:30 – 16:45	Next steps
16:45	End of session

Department announcements

1. Promotion to UHD: José Antolínez
2. Faculty SPM session
3. Staff update: Dijana Boric starting a new role; Laurens is now our business controller.
4. First succesful run Hydraulic Engineering solutions in a changing environment
    1. Caroline Grilo, Mark Voorendt, Kieran Dunne Alex Kirichek, Bas Hofland, Marion Tissier

HE Vision and Mission

Final?

Hydraulic Engineering for a resilient and sustainable future

Vision:

We believe Hydraulic Engineering is at the core of a safe, resilient, and sustainable civil system, where people and the environment thrive. Our focus is on enhancing the design and performance of hydraulic systems, improving infrastructure, strengthening climate adaptation and hazard resilience, and accelerating the transition to clean energy.

Mission:

We fulfil this vision through world-leading education, research and valorisation in the field of hydraulic engineering. Through our unique education we empower the next generation of hydraulic engineers to bring new knowledge and innovation to the field. Our cutting-edge research is grounded in a deep understanding of hydraulic structures, processes, and system dynamics, synergizing fieldwork, theory, modelling, laboratory experiments and new technologies. We achieve real world impact and address global challenges by actively collaborating with governments, industry, and academic partners to deliver practical and sustainable engineering solutions for society.

We embrace the TU Delft values by fostering an academic leadership and working environment that promotes diversity, inclusion, equity, integrity and courage.

What is a department?

According to the Faculty Department Organisational Principles (DOP):

A unit of:

1. Planning and control – e.g. positioning of the department, setting overall scientific direction and focus, development and execution of strategy and departmental plans, fulfillment of administrative duties.

2. Education, research and valorization – e.g. initiation (but also evaluation and if necessary, merge, downsize or stop) of research programs/ themes, assignment of teaching duties, external representation/communication.

3. Human resources management e.g. talent acquisition, (academic) career progression, results and development cycle, strategic personnel management, HSE, social safety, wellbeing, working conditions and culture.

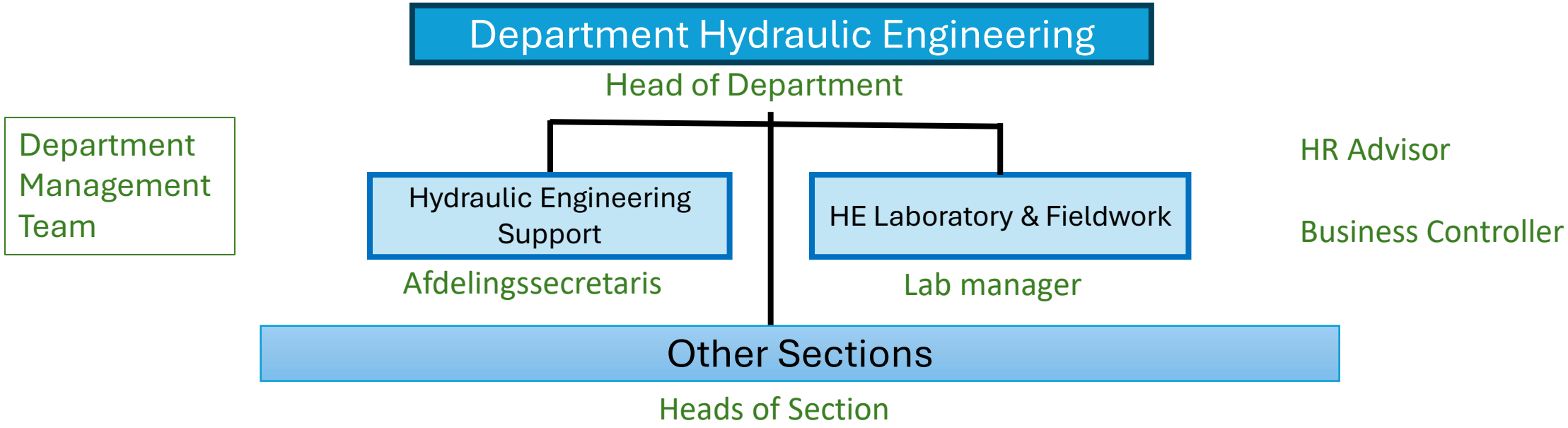
4. Financial management e.g. budget development and control, portfolio management of projects, time writing, project effect, enforcing financial discipline and risk assessment of all projects.

What is a Department?

According to the Faculty Department Organisational Principles (DOP):

The (vertical) line of command in a department is department chair, section head, staff.

Departmental support staff is organized at departmental level (i.e. not at section level) by default, e.g. in the form of a department secretariat and a department laboratory.



What is a Section?

According to the Faculty Department Organisational Principles (DOP):

- Sections can vary in size between 20-60 scientific staff* .
- Each scientific staff member is a hierarchical member of only one section
- As criteria in the composition of sections could be used:
  - Related and/or coherent research themes and expertise
  - Sense of belonging for scientific and support staff
  - Facilitating access for the outside world to specialist knowledge and expertise
  - Facilitating department-wide cooperation, solidarity and alignment of goals
  - Balanced distribution of workload and feasible span of control
  - Balanced diversity in terms of seniority, gender and nationality
  - Future-proofness for the next decade
  - Broad support of scientific staff

‘Scientific staff’ means (i) assistant, associate and full professors including staff in an Academic Career Track (ACT), (ii) permanent and temporary teaching staff/lecturers (‘docenten’) and (iii) permanent and temporary early career research staff (‘onderzoekers’), the latter including PhD candidates (PhDs), Engineering Doctorates (EngDs), Post-doctoral researchers (Postdocs) and Researchers.

Drivers for revisiting our current Sections

- Create alignment with our new vision and mission.
- No. of staff in EFM will reduce in the next 5 years due to planned retirements.
- No. of staff in R&P has reduced due to people changing jobs.
- Creating a stronger alignment with teaching
- Clearer external visibility.
- Accomodating better current and future research/education ambitions

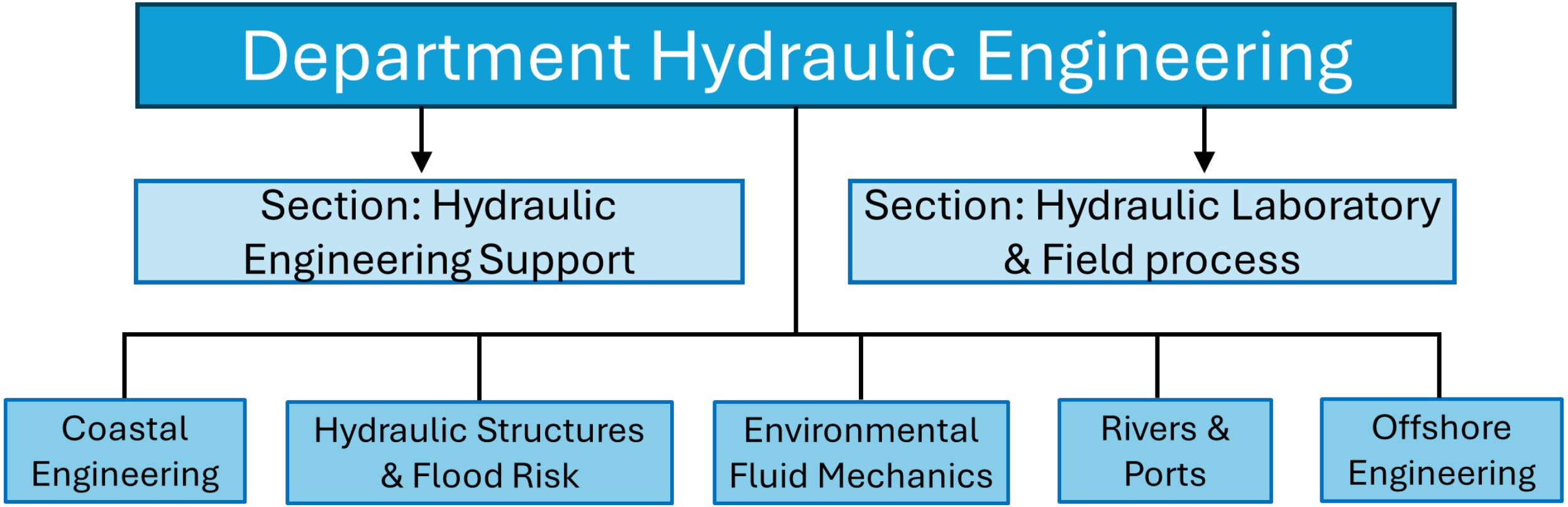
Today's activities

1. Exploring some potential Section Scenarios drawn from Session 3

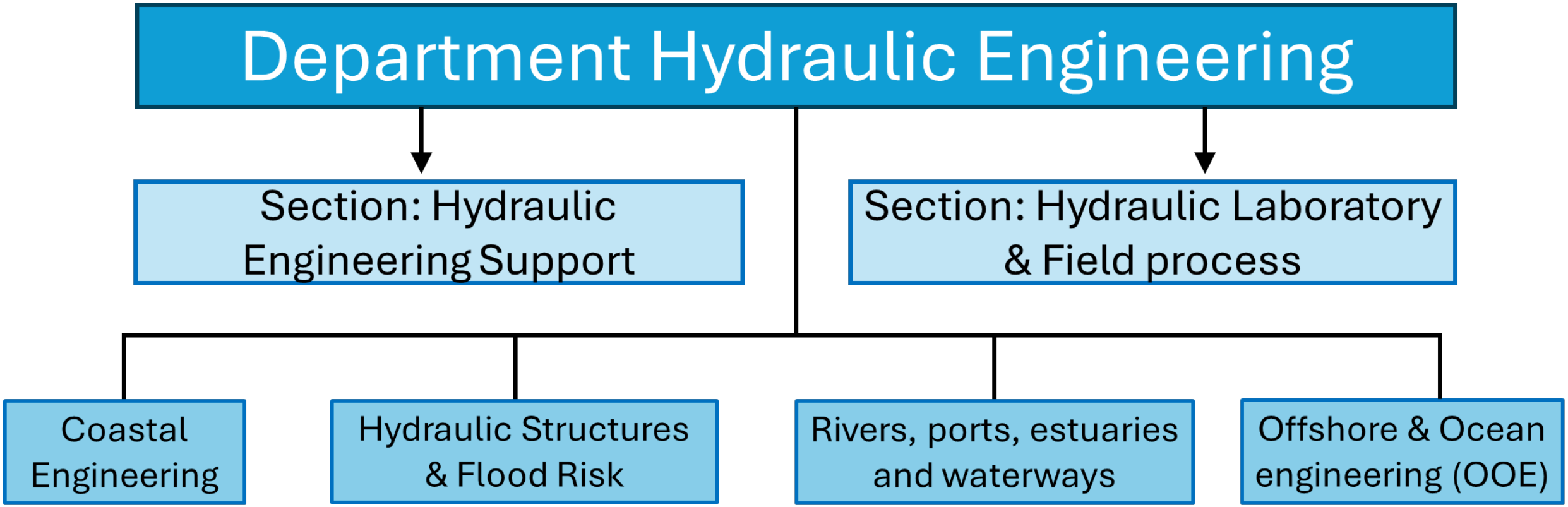
2. Establishing horizontal working groups to help achieve our 7 achievements (from Session 2) of 2035

Activity 1: Exploring HE section scenarios for the future

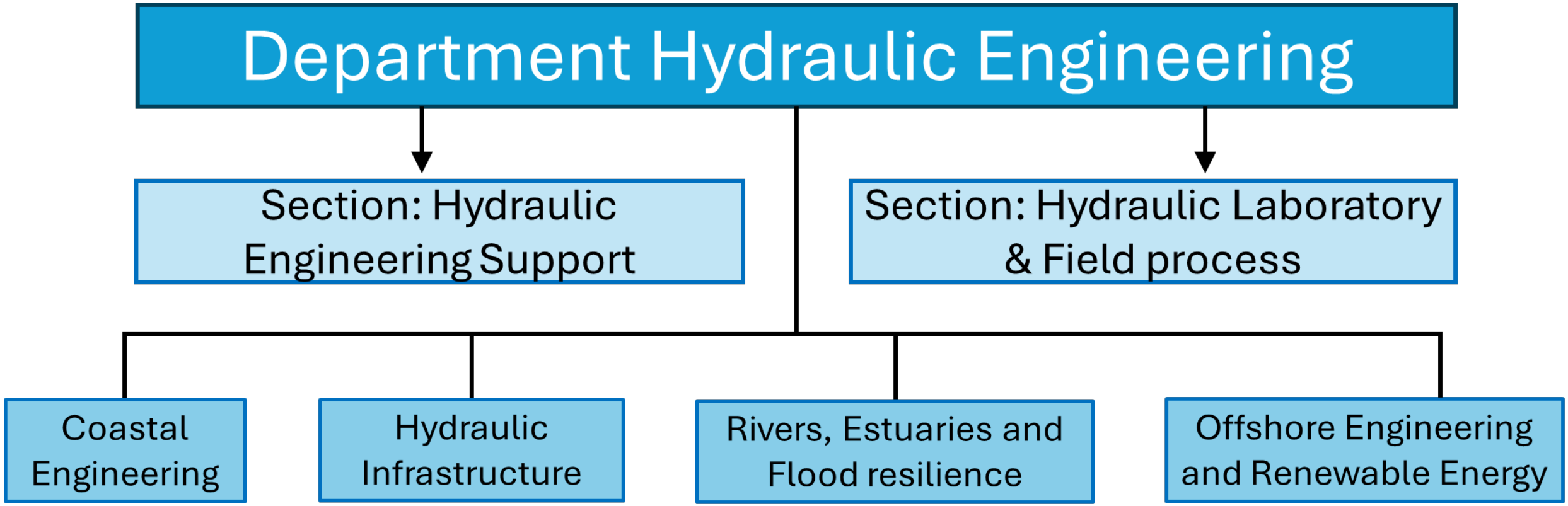
Scenario 1 : Current structure



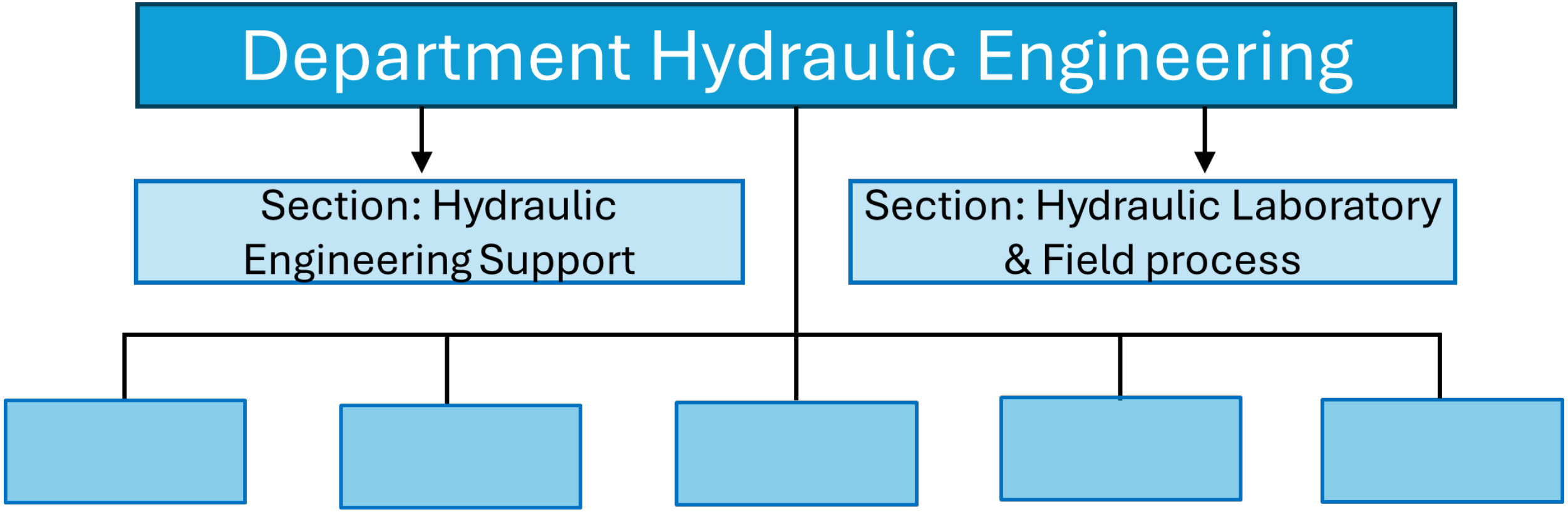
Scenario 2 : Geographical distribution



Scenario 3 : Thematical distribution



Scenario 4 : Alternative proposals



Activity 1A- Assessing section scenarios

Assignment:

Study the three section scenarios.

Map current department topics and future themes onto each scenario (see sticker sheet)

Feel free to add extra themes if they are not represented but should be.

Questions:

1. Do the section scenarios adequately represent the department topics now and in the future?
2. Discuss the advantages and disadvantages of each scenario

Timing

- 60 minutes group exercise
- 15 feedback from groups.

Activity 1B- Scenario positioning & preference

Assignment:

You have three blue stickers and one green sticker.

- For each section scenario add a coloured sticker to the section where you think you would fit best, or on the blank section if none of sections feels appropriate.
- Use the green sticker to indicate your preferred scenario

Timing

- 10 minutes, but use the coffee break as well
- Reflection post coffee break

BREAK TIME

Activity 2: Cross departmental working groups

Sections aren't enough:

In Session 2 we looked at how to achieve our Vision and Mission

The results of the session were 7 ambitious achievements for the Department by 2035

We identified a number of activities that we could do towards these achievements

These provide a roadmap.

They are department-wide activities that require some better coordination and collaboration.

The 7 HE Achievements:

1. **We conduct scientifically excellent and societally relevant research that has impact.**
2. **Our MSc and PhD graduates are recognised as top professionals and take on leadership roles in academia, industry, and government.**
3. **We maintain strong partnerships with industry and public stakeholders, co-developing innovative solutions with measurable impact.**
4. **Our education is world leading. (should it be open to people beyond TU Delft?).**
5. **We operate world-class, unique lab and field research infrastructure, and have realized a modern, sustainable facility in Delft.**
6. **We have a global presence and influence.**
7. **The department is a proactive, efficient, inclusive team that supports TU Delft values. We operate a strong, supportive and healthy working culture.**

Working Groups

- Safety

(to include HSE committee*, Social and Psychological safety)

- Education
- Research
- External engagement
- Lab& fieldwork

(vision already requested)

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General Terms of Reference for WGs

- Each WG is composed of one representatives from each section and works as a team to help implement and further shape the department Strategy
- WGs do not aim to take over any individual activities by staff members, but rather provide greater coordination and guidance towards our Department achievements.,
- WG's will support, publicise, connect and grow activities in their area, highlight avenues for funding, and try to create new opportunities
- WGs must meet regularly and will report to, and advise, the HE MT
- WG will present at All Staff meetings once per term
- Membership of the WG should be seen as a leadership and enabling activity and count in career progression
- Each WG section member is responsible for providing 2-way communication between the WG and the Section

Activity 2 – Defining mandates for each WG

Assignment

Define a mandate for each WG

Instructions:

1. Look at the activities associated with the 7 achievements and identify which might fall under each WG
2. What other activities that are conducted by the Department on a regular basis could they help to manage/coordinate?
3. Are there other activities you would like them to do?

Based on the above, define a rough mandate for each WG and their first priority activity

Timing:

1. 40 minutes
2. 5 minutes reflection per group.

Next steps

Vision and Mision

- Finalisation by the board during the next departmental MT.

Section structure:

- We'll process your input from both activities and share a summary with the department.
- This will be a longer process, including
  - Stakeholder and internal consultations
  - discussions with HR and Finance before any proposal is made

For the working groups:

  - Draft the full term of references using the input of today.
  - Put out a call for participation.

We'll keep you informed.

End of the session:

Thank you for your input!